

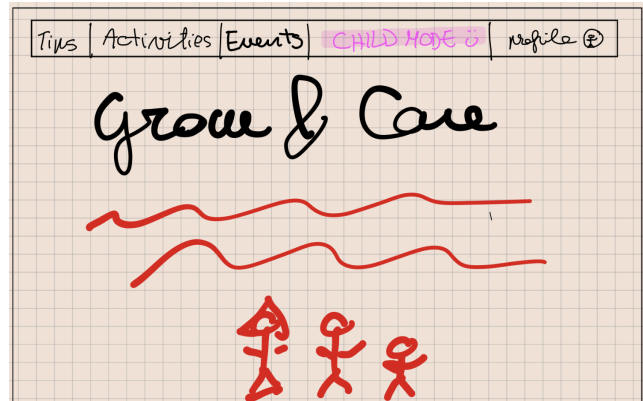
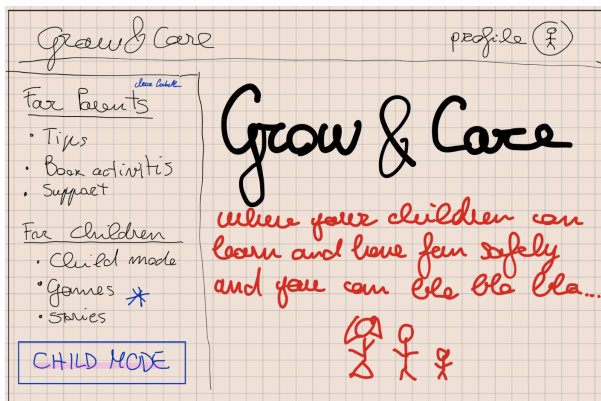
Grow & Care

Stage 3: Paper prototype

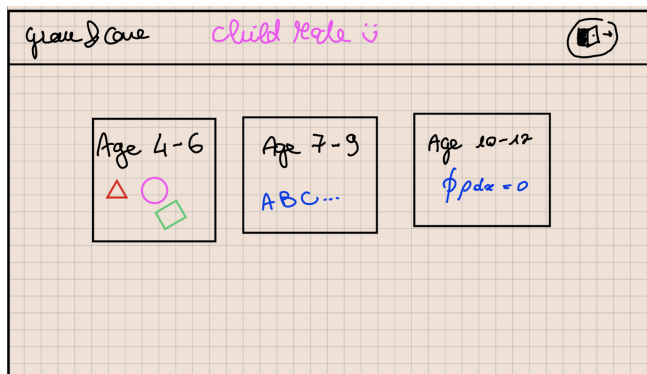
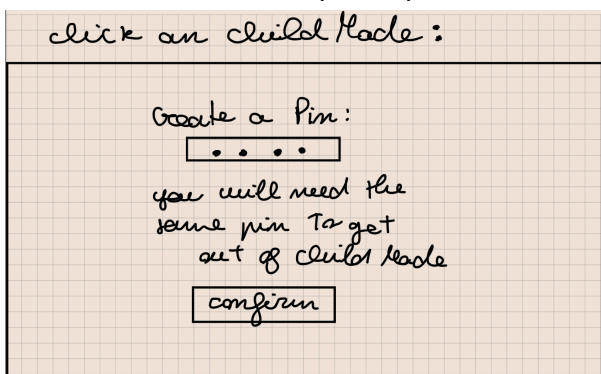
Sketches

Below are the initial sketches created during the early stages of our design process.

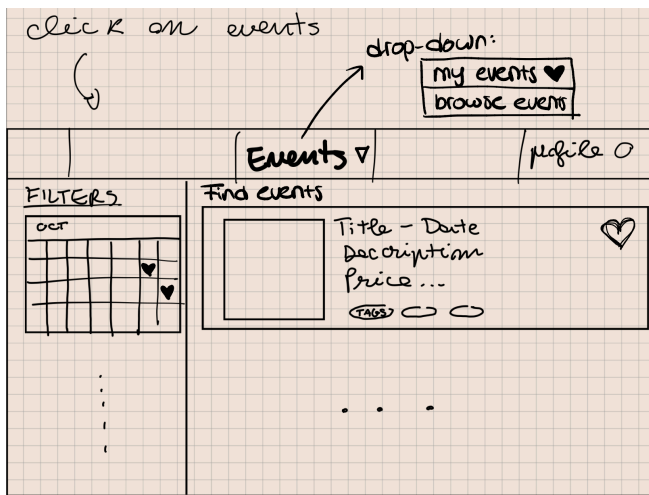
We had two versions of what the **homepage** should look like. Later we decided on the right one with the menu bar at the top.



Our **Child Mode** ideas hasn't changed since the first draft, since the whole idea of Child Mode is to have an interface as simple as possible:



We added details over time, like adding drop-down menus and splitting the events page into “**My Events**” for saved events and “**Browse events**” for exploring. The activities page went through the same changes, being very similar.

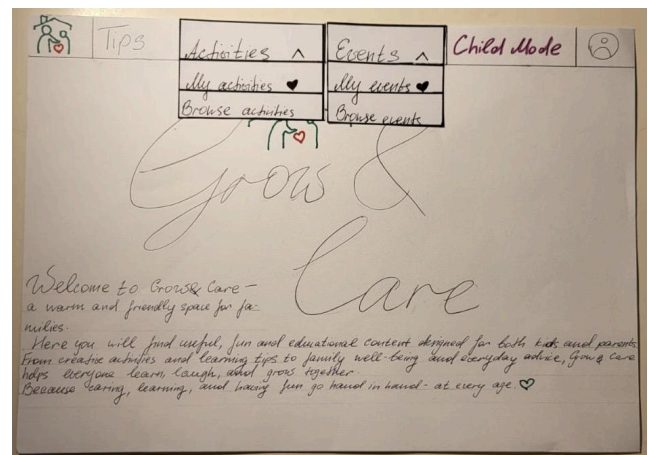
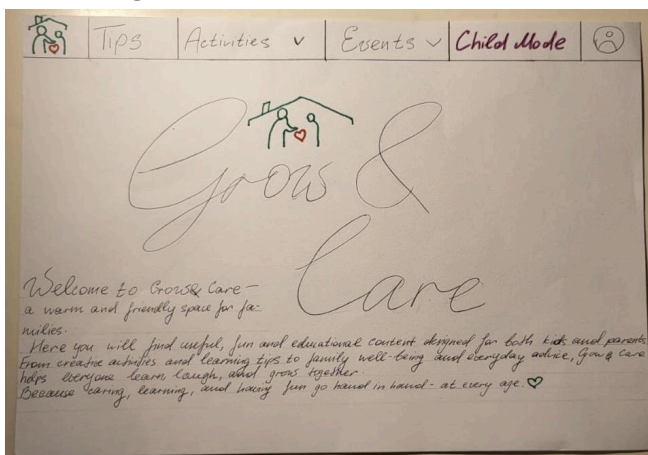


In the first draft, we wanted to have parent and children profiles. We ditched the children's profiles later on, as we found it redundant with the filters present on the events/activities pages. The **main profile** underwent minor modifications.

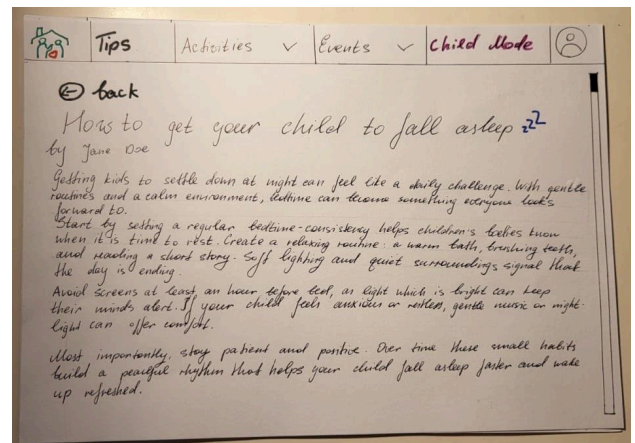
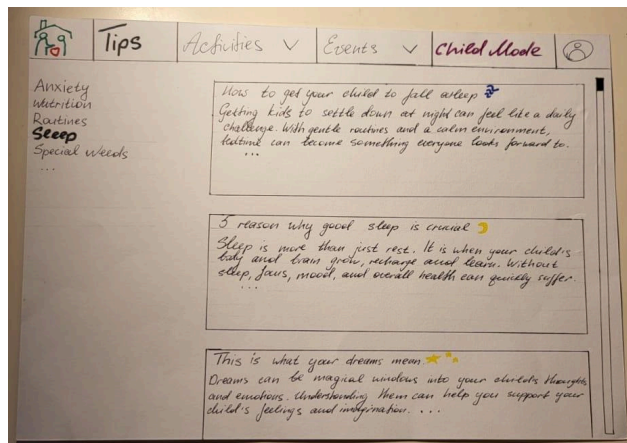
Prototype Photos

The following pictures show some salient interfaces of the paper prototype.

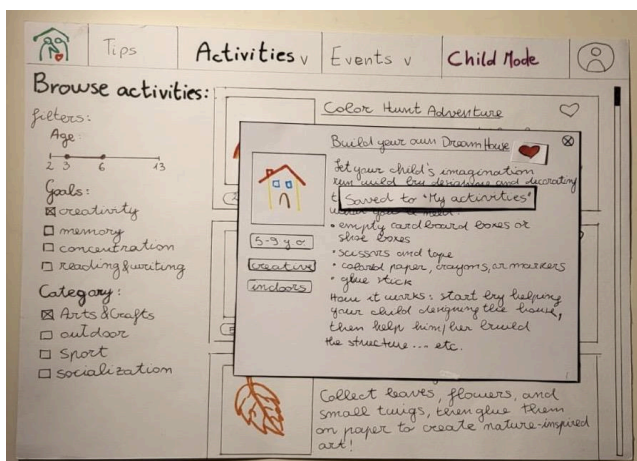
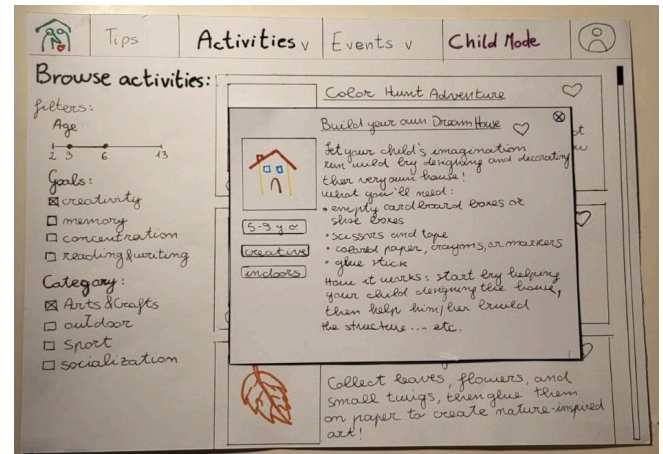
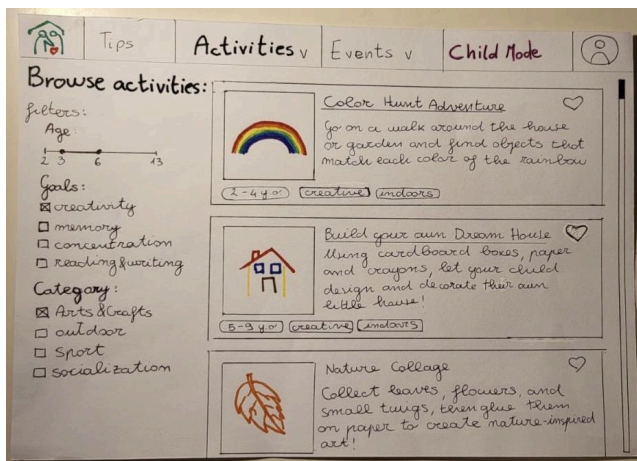
Home-Page and drop-down menus for Activities / Events:



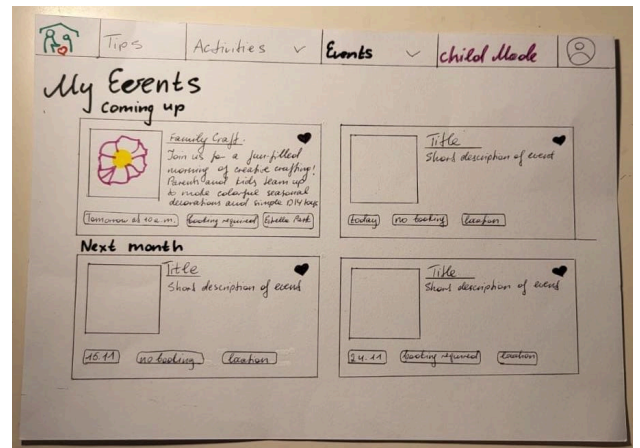
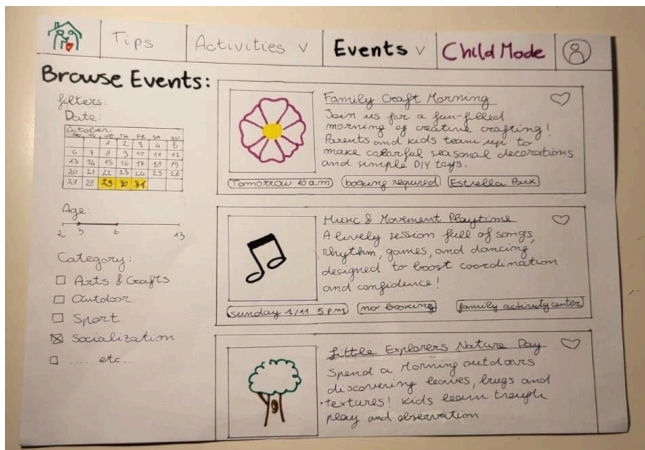
Clicking on Tips → clicking on an article:



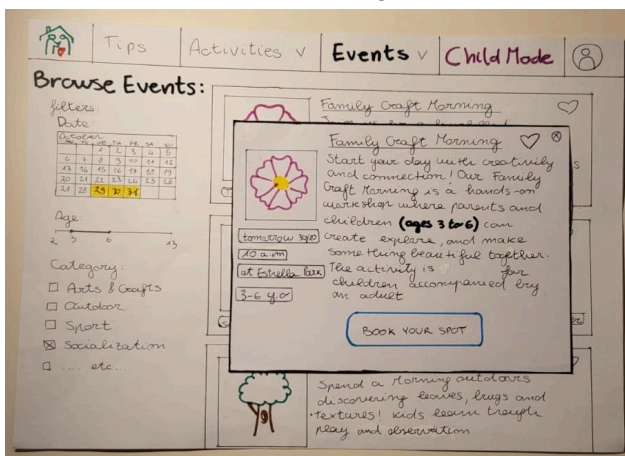
Activities: After selecting “Browse Activities” from the drop-down menu → Pop-up-window after clicking on an event to read more about it → Activities can be saved to “My Activities” by clicking on the outlined heart, which will then become a solid red heart.



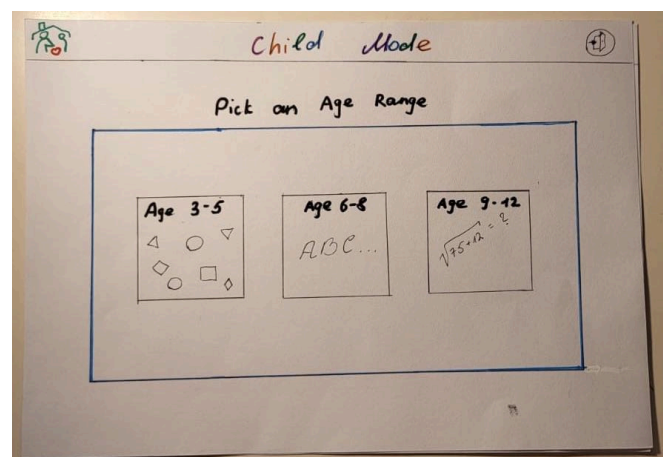
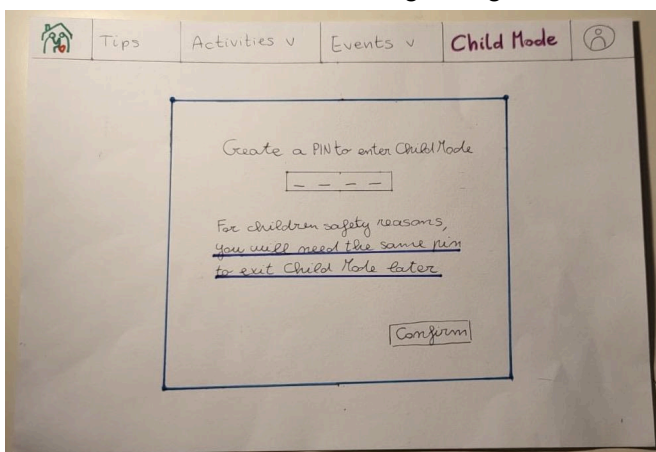
Events: Selecting “Browse Events” vs. “My Events” from the drop-down menu. Events can be saved to “My Events” by clicking on the outlined heart, which will then become a solid red heart.



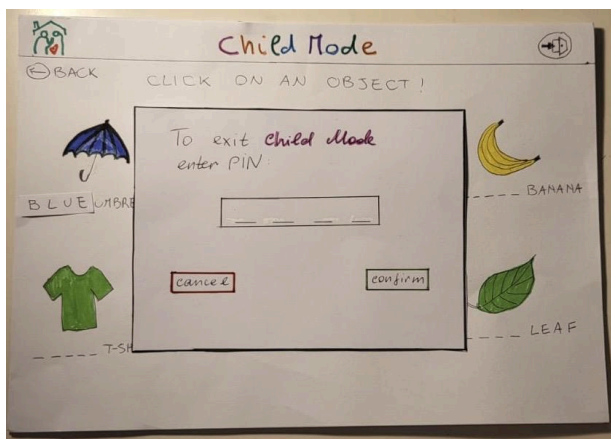
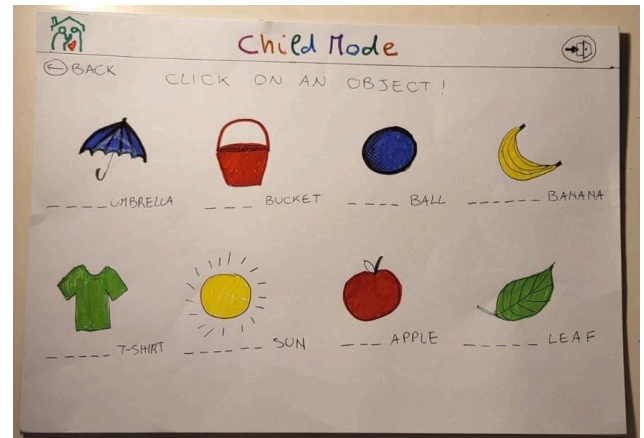
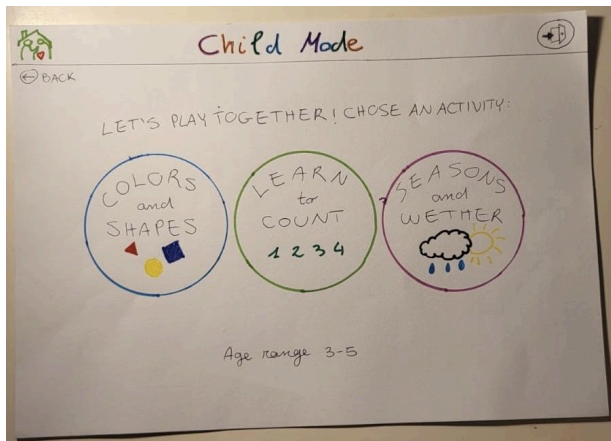
Pop-up-window after clicking on on event to read more about it:



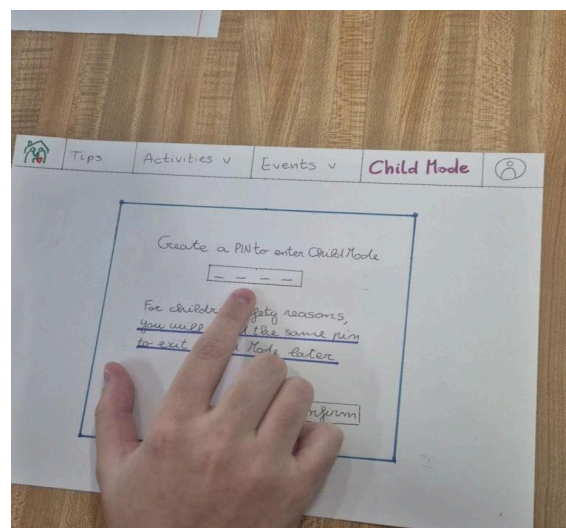
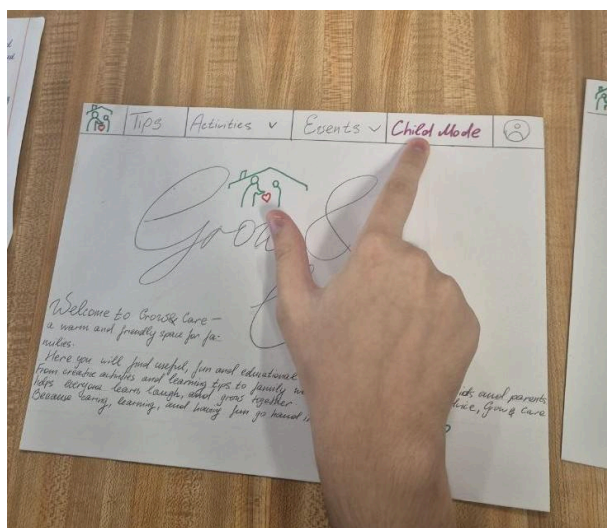
Enter **Child Mode** → Pick an age range within Child Mode



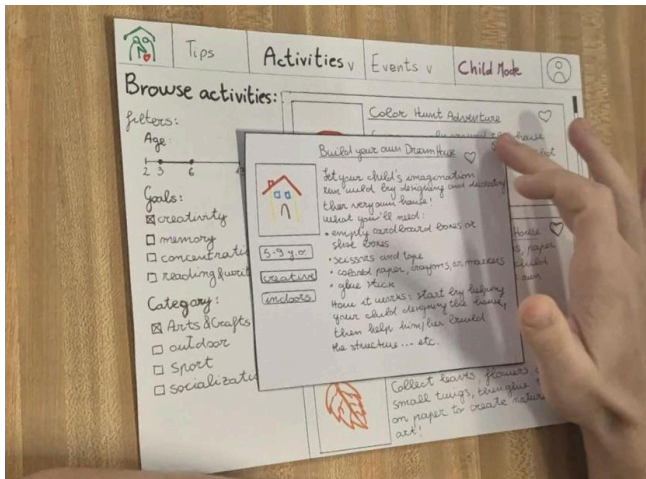
Select a **game** → play the game → try to **exit** Child Mode



Photos were also taken during the tests. The following images illustrate key components of the prototype and document user interactions observed during the testing sessions.



The images above illustrate the **4th scenario**, where the parent selects Child Mode and creates a PIN in order to enter it.



Closing pop-up window in activities after selecting Activities → Browse Activities → clicking on activity to see further details.

Briefing

The following section presents the briefing employed during the testing session:

Grow&Care is a web platform designed to help parents and caregivers easily find trustworthy, age-appropriate, and personalized activities that support their children's development.

Resources like, ideas for activities, social events, or tips and articles are scattered across different websites and social media pages, making it difficult to identify what is truly suitable for each child's age, interests, and developmental needs. As a result, caregivers often feel overwhelmed by information overload and unsure of where to begin. Grow&Care addresses these issues by bringing together curated, high-quality resources in one place. It helps users discover and plan activities tailored to their child's profile, offering both practical ideas for daily use, opportunities to connect with the local community.

Scenarios

The scenarios outlined below were used during the testing day.

Scenario 1

Anna, mother of a 6-year-old kid, wants to find craft ideas that she can do with her daughter. She's looking for things that can be done indoors focused on the art-and-craft world and wants to save them for later browsing.

Scenario 2

Anna wants her 6-year-old daughter to get better at socializing and is looking for social events that will help her daughter achieve this. She wants to find and book an event scheduled for this week.

Scenario 3:

Anna's child has a difficult time falling asleep, she wants to find tips to help her young child fall asleep more easily.

Scenario 4.1:

Anna wants her 4 year-old child Tom to play an online game appropriate for his age while being sure that he will find a child-safe website area.

Scenario 4.2:

Little Tom wants to play a game involving colors and shapes. After a while, he gets bored and wants to explore the rest of the website.

Observation

During the tests, participants were overall able to complete the main tasks successfully. Most described the interface as intuitive, smooth, and visually simple which reduces the cognitive load and simplifies the completion of the task.

Nevertheless, the user feedback helped us to identify a few areas that can be improved:

The most prominent issue was the 'Child Mode' feature. The name may be ambiguous, because several users had difficulties with the last scenario, where Ana wants her child to play a game appropriate for his age. For the user it wasn't clear where the games were located: some users clicked on 'My Activities' first, before discovering 'Child Mode'.

Some possible solutions to this issue are:

- Changing the name 'Child Mode' to something more intuitive.
- Adding hints on the home page regarding 'Child Mode' such as "Now with the new MODE - CHILD MODE, including games, learning material and more!" marked in the same color as the 'Child Mode' button in the navigation bar.
- Adding a meaningful pictogram like a dice or a puzzle piece to the 'Child Mode' button to make it clear that it includes online games.

Furthermore, minor suggestions for the home page were made, one of them being reducing the amount of text on the main page and adding a video instead. Regarding the amount of text, we argue that it will be less overwhelming once presented as typed instead of handwritten.

Overall, the users were satisfied with the prototype. They declared it easy to use and visually appealing. Further improvements should focus on clarifying navigation cues, and making the homepage more engaging with visual elements instead of relying solely on text.